HTML Form Elements

A closer look at the elements you can use inside a <form>

OVERVIEW

The HTML <form> Elements

A <form> element can contain one or more of the following form elements:

`<input>`	`<label>`	`<select>`	`<textarea>`	`<button>`
`<fieldset>`	`<legend>`	`<datalist>`	`<option>`	`<optgroup>`

This deck covers each of these in detail on the following slides.

The <input> Element

One of the most used form elements. It can be displayed in several ways, depending on the type attribute.

```
<label for="fname">First name:</label>
<input type="text" id="fname" name="fname">
```

NOTE

All the different values of the type attribute (text, email, checkbox, radio, etc.) are their own topic — see "HTML Input Types" for the full list.

FORM ELEMENTS

The <label> Element

Defines a label for a form element. The for attribute should match the id of the input to bind them together.

WHY USE <label>?

- Screen readers announce the label when the user focuses on the input — helps accessibility
- Clicking the label text also activates the linked input — helpful for small radio buttons/checkboxes

```
<label for="fname">First name:</label>  <input type="text" id="fname" name="fname">
```

FORM ELEMENTS

The <select> Element

Defines a drop-down list. Each choice inside it is an <option> element.

```
<select id="cars" name="cars">
  <option value="volvo">Volvo</option>
  <option value="saab">Saab</option>
  <option value="fiat">Fiat</option>
  <option value="audi">Audi</option>
</select>
```

KEY POINTS

By default, the first <option> is selected

Add selected to an <option> to pre-select it

e.g. <option value="fiat" selected>

<select> — Visible Values & Multiple Choice

SIZE ATTRIBUTE

Use size to specify how many options are visible at once.

```
<select id="cars" name="cars" size="3">
  <option value="volvo">Volvo</option>
  <option value="saab">Saab</option>
  <option value="fiat">Fiat</option>
  <option value="audi">Audi</option>
</select>
```

MULTIPLE ATTRIBUTE

Add multiple to let the user select more than one value.

```
<select id="cars" name="cars"
  size="4" multiple>
  <option value="volvo">Volvo</option>
  <option value="saab">Saab</option>
  ...
</select>
```

The <textarea> Element

Defines a multi-line input field. rows sets the visible number of lines; cols sets the visible width.

```
<textarea name="message" rows="10" cols="30">
  The cat was playing in the garden.
</textarea>
```

STYLING WITH CSS

```
<textarea name="message"
  style="width:200px; height:600px;">
  ...
</textarea>
```

You can size a text area with rows/cols or with CSS width and height.

The <button> Element

Defines a clickable button.

```
<button type="button" onclick="alert('Hello World!')">
  Click Me!
</button>
```

IMPORTANT

Always specify the type attribute for the button element. Different browsers may use different default types.

The <fieldset> and <legend> Elements

<fieldset> groups related data in a form. <legend> defines a caption for that group.

```
<form action="save.html" target="_blank">
  <fieldset>
    <legend>Information:</legend>
    <label for="fname">First name:</label><br>
    <input type="text" id="fname" name="fname" value="John"><br>
    <label for="lname">Last name:</label><br>
    <input type="text" id="lname" name="lname" value="Doe"><br><br>
    <input type="submit" value="Submit">
  </fieldset>
</form>
```

FORM ELEMENTS

The <datalist> Element

Specifies a list of pre-defined options for an <input> element. Users see a drop-down list of suggestions as they type.

```
<form action="save.html">
  <input list="browsers">
  <datalist id="browsers">
    <option value="Edge">
    <option value="Firefox">
    <option value="Chrome">
    <option value="Opera">
    <option value="Safari">
  </datalist>
</form>
```

KEY RULE

The list attribute of the <input> element must match the id attribute of the <datalist> element.

QUICK REFERENCE

HTML Form Elements — Summary

`<form>`	Defines an HTML form for user input
`<input>`	Defines an input control
`<textarea>`	Defines a multiline input control (text area)
`<label>`	Defines a label for an <input> element
`<fieldset>`	Groups related elements in a form
`<legend>`	Defines a caption for a <fieldset> element
`<select>`	Defines a drop-down list
`<optgroup>`	Defines a group of related options in a drop-down list
`<option>`	Defines an option in a drop-down list
`<button>`	Defines a clickable button
`<datalist>`	Specifies a list of pre-defined options for input controls

THAT'S THE CORE SET OF FORM ELEMENTS!